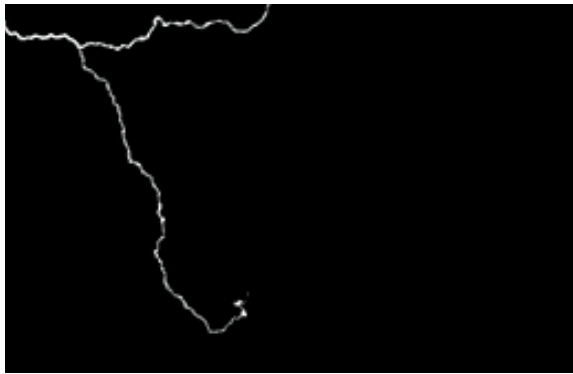


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stacker.news weekly zine



Issue #31

Oct 25 - Oct 31

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SAYS

, happy
HALLOWEEN



and

WHITE
PAPER
DAY

Stacker News Zine is made
each week in Austin, TX by
[@plebpoet](#). When you write a
good post on [stacker.news](#),
you might see it show up in
print! Don't worry, I try to
make you look good ;)

Note from the Editor

Scary to think who I would be now if I
never tried to understand bitcoin. I would
probably still be depressed, without hope
in the future, obsessing over the political
drama of the day. I might not have found
a way to make art. That's enough to give
me the halloween heebie-jeebies!
But that's not where we are, we're here!



TOP BOOST

Need NO-BS advice on Multi-Sig Custody from Stacker News

2211 sats \ 10k boost \ 19 comments \ [@anon](#) 24 oct bitcoin



Bitcoin: A Peer-to-Peer Electronic Cash System

Satoshi Nakamoto
satoshi@gmx.com
www.bitcoin.org

Abstract. A purely peer-to-peer version of electronic cash would allow online payments to be sent directly from one party to another without going through a financial institution. Digital signatures provide part of the solution, but the main benefits are lost if a trusted third party is still required to prevent double-spending. We propose a solution to the double-spending problem using a peer-to-peer network. The network timestamps transactions by hashing them into an ongoing chain of hash-based proof-of-work, forming a record that cannot be changed without redoing the proof-of-work. The longest chain not only serves as proof of the sequence of events witnessed, but proof that it came from the largest pool of CPU power. As long as a majority of CPU power is controlled by nodes that are not cooperating to attack the network, they'll generate the longest chain and outpace attackers. The network itself requires minimal structure. Messages are broadcast on a best effort basis, and nodes can leave and rejoin the network at will, accepting the longest proof-of-work chain as proof of what happened while they were gone.

1. Introduction

Commerce on the Internet has come to rely almost exclusively on financial institutions serving as trusted third parties to process electronic payments. While the system works well enough for most transactions, it still suffers from the inherent weaknesses of the trust based model. Completely non-reversible transactions are not really possible, since financial institutions cannot avoid mediating disputes. The cost of mediation increases transaction costs, limiting the minimum practical transaction size and cutting off the possibility for small casual transactions, and there is a broader cost in the loss of ability to make non-reversible payments for non-reversible services. With the possibility of reversal, the need for trust spreads. Merchants must be wary of their customers, hassling them for more information than they would otherwise need. A certain percentage of fraud is accepted as unavoidable. These costs and payment uncertainties can be avoided in person by using physical currency, but no mechanism exists to make payments over a communications channel without a trusted party.

What is needed is an electronic payment system based on cryptographic proof instead of trust, allowing any two willing parties to transact directly with each other without the need for a trusted third party. Transactions that are computationally impractical to reverse would protect sellers from fraud, and routine escrow mechanisms could easily be implemented to protect buyers. In this paper, we propose a solution to the double-spending problem using a peer-to-peer distributed timestamp server to generate computational proof of the chronological order of transactions. The system is secure as long as honest nodes collectively control more CPU power than any cooperating group of attacker nodes.

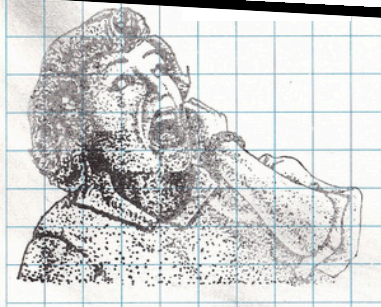


nakamoto
institute
.org

TOP BOOST

Parasite Wars - Feed Distribution Systems

615 sats \ 10k boost \ 4 comments \
[@zapsammy](#) 29 oct food_and_drinks



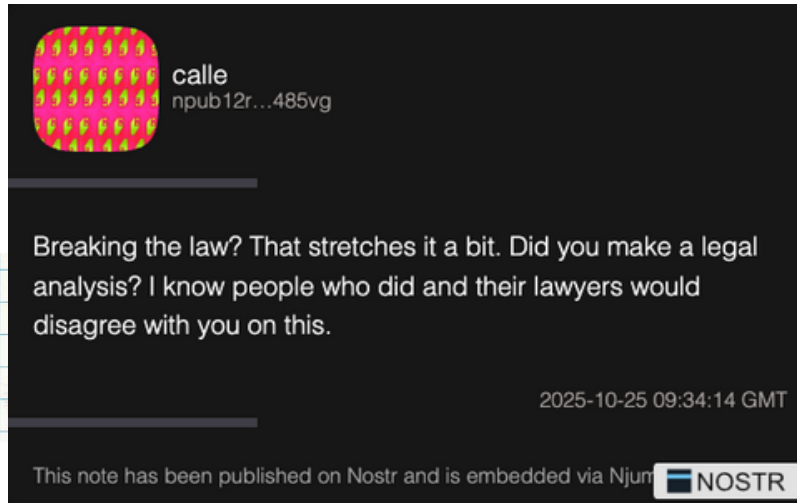
ONE POLL

Are Cashu mint operators breaking the law?



1670 sats \ 101 comments \ @ek 25 oct bitcoin

@calle seems to think they are not breaking the law, see this note:



I'm pretty sure they are considered [MSBs](#) that break money transmission laws without KYC/AML and a license in each state they operate in.

I thought that was clear to everyone using Cashu, especially the one who invented the protocol.



What do you think?

YES	60.0%
NO	40.0%

TWO POLL



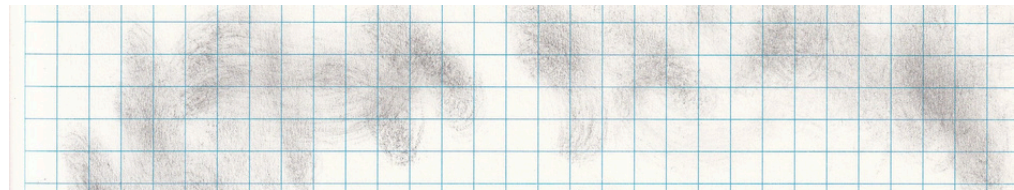
Which is Worse: Taxes or Fiat Money?

1221 sats \ 101 comments \ @kepford 27 oct econ

- Taxes are theft.
- Fiat is manipulation of the base money in an economy by a few.

If you could snap your fingers and eliminate one forever but no other which would you choose to eliminate?

FIAT - (NO MONEY PRINTER	61.5%
TAXES - ALL TAXES (BUT NOT FIAT)	38.5%



DO YOU LIKE POLLS?

sure

☐

nah

☐

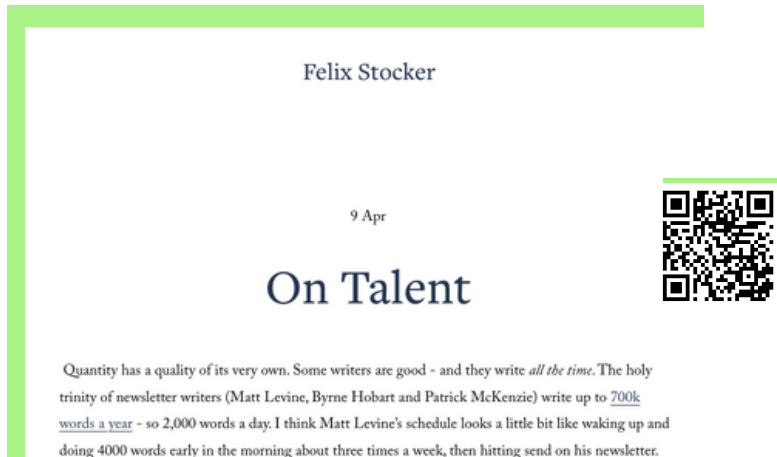


Talent redux

7452 sats \ 22 comments \ [@elvism Mercury](#) 27 oct

mostly_harmless

A week ago I read this article on [talent](#) and decided I had to quit my job.



Quitting was an idea I had noodled on for ... years, I guess. But I was so entangled with the place, even as it poisoned me. It would be like seceding from your family, or your religion. Or pulling a full-grown tree out of the ground, the roots that aren't torn off still clinging to the dirt.

But I read the article and was like: I have to go. I have to. I gave notice the next day. Two days after that it was over. It's been weird hearing the inside of my head again.

Then I thought: didn't I share that article on SN? I had a hazy memory of having done so. I hadn't been to SN in months, for reasons related to work. But I'm free now, I thought. I should share it if I haven't.

Turns out I was right, I had already [posted about the article](#) 18 months ago. I'd forgotten the rest of what I wrote in that post. Re-reading it hits like a brick to the face.

Time to see if all this struggle has meant anything. *



In one sentence, what is your life's story?

1225 sats \ 66 comments \ [@k00b](#) 28 oct asksn

zaps forwarded to [@billytheked](#) [100%]

In one sentence explain your life's story. *

Inspired by [@billytheked](#)'s deleted [post\[1\]](#).

1. they titled a post "in one sentence explain" which i thought was a metaprompt so I prompted "your life story." 🗨

comments

160 sats \ 4 replies \ [@Scoresby](#) 28 Oct

I am hoping to trick myself into greatness with near-constant delusions of grandeur.

42 sats \ 0 replies \ [@anon](#) 28 Oct

I am nothing waiting to die.

21 sats \ 0 replies \ [@ProofOfWorkFitness](#) 28 Oct

Almost too good to be true.

21 sats \ 0 replies \ [@Aardvark](#) 28 Oct

Almost good enough. *

79 sats \ 0 replies \ [@nelom](#) 28 Oct

Raised amid wealth's comforts yet plagued by inner awkwardness and decades of aimless drift, arrived at a poised maturity, clear eyed about my direction and desires.

79 sats \ 0 replies \ [@optimism](#) 28 Oct

Fucked.



No. There is zero need for BIP 444.

2517 sats \ 19 comments \ @theariard 29 oct bitcoin

shared to the bitcoin-dev ML for initial discussion:

<https://groups.google.com/g/bitcoinddev/c/nOZim6FbuF8/m/FUbFjHYZAgAJ>

Hi Dathon Ohm,

I did a cursory review of your BIP proposal, not on the technical matter as there is no reference implementation available, but I did one on the legalities raised in the text (grep'ing the word "legal" one can find 15 references versus only 2 references to the word "technical").

Under European law, there is a clearly established line of jurisprudences exonerating internet service providers or hosting operators to have to install a system for filtering all electronic communications passing via its services which would apply indiscriminately to all its users for any kind of content (CJUE, 24-11-2011, aff C-70/10 Scarlet Extended SA c/ SABAM, CJUE, 16-02-2012, aff C-260/10 SABAM c/ Netlog).

Rather to engage in generic filtering on the burden of services providers, courts have generally yielded decisions asking for fine-grained deletion of a specific content, as a safeguard of other interest at stake, notably users's right to privacy [0].

Further, in the eventuality of an extended filtering system would have to be put in place by a service provider, and if said filtering system design would be unable to dissociate between legal content and illegal content, the introduction of this filtering system would constitute an infringement of the freedom of expression and information (CJUE, 26-04-2022, aff C-401/19). Those judicial decisions are literally encompassing peer-to-peer softwares in their scope, as somehow before Bitcoin, they was something called Bittorent.

Moreover, this line of jurisprudence underlights that any interference with one's fundamental right of expression should be lay down under clear and precise rules governing the scope of the interference. This is not a mere formality, as again and again too restrictives measures are strike down (CEDH, 02-02-2016, Index.hu/Hungary, aff. n° 22947/13). As far as I know, I'm not aware of any European continental country that has made a legislation on how one is allowed to use his right to the freedom of expression in the context of publishing stuff in a Bitcoin block.

Under the US law, I won't risk making legal comment for now, as for anyone who is following the work of the Electronic Frontier Foundation from times to times, there is a pending case in front of the US Supreme Court, Cox Communications, Inc vs. Sony Music Entertainment specifiially on the liability of Internet service providers. But given that US culturally are more protective of the freedom of expression, this would be an even higher bar to restrain freedom of expression.

I concur with Gregory Maxwell. There is zero need to change the consensus rules.

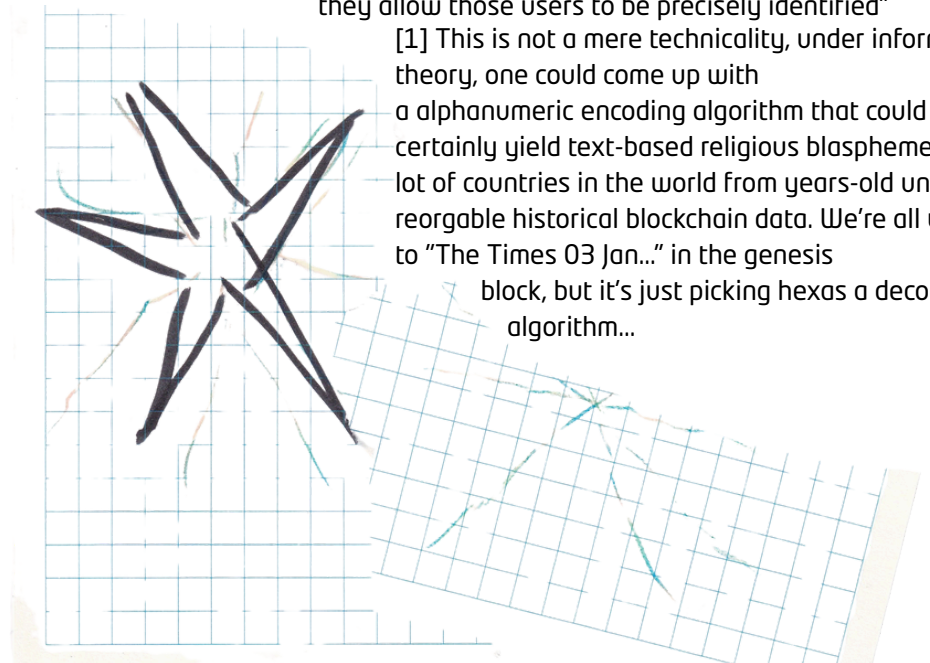
In the idea one would like to limit one's responsibility arising from how bitcoin consensus data can be encoded or decoded to "obviously" "illegal" content (as strictly defined by a specific national legislation) [1], fuzzy encoders and decoders for end-to-end or point-to-point communication could be formalized as BIP documents, that would put an asymmetric cost on the decoders, with the upper bound being the impossibility of decoding.

Fuzzy algorithms is not sci-fi tech it's actually what is used for Minisketch.

Best,
Antoine

[0] "Those addresses are protected personal data because they allow those users to be precisely identified"

[1] This is not a mere technicality, under information theory, one could come up with a alphanumeric encoding algorithm that could certainly yield text-based religious blaspheme in a lot of countries in the world from years-old un-reorgable historical blockchain data. We're all used to "The Times 03 Jan..." in the genesis block, but it's just picking hexas a decoding algorithm...





Review of Jimmy Song v. Peter Todd filters debate (Plan B Lugano)

3946 sats \ 55 comments \ @simplestacker 30 oct bitcoin

ICYMI: Jimmy Song debated Peter Todd over the topic of spam filters at Plan B Lugano 2025. You can see the video here, starting at around 7:25:00 (yes--the video is 10 hours long)

Jimmy took the pro-filter position, and Peter took the anti. The format was 6 minute introductions followed by 3 minute rebuttals, followed by a more open discussion.

Opening statements

The moderator led off by asking the audience their pre-existing positions. About 40% of the room was pro-filter, 20% anti-filter, and 40% undecided. Jimmy's position clearly has the popular support.

Jimmy then entered into a polished 6 minute intro. His main points were:

- Filters do work. Many nodes already perform filtering whether you know it or not, like not forwarding txs with data in the taproot annex, or tx with P2PKH outputs <546 sats. Yet, they are consensus valid and you can find them in blocks. But they're rare precisely because filters work.
- No filters at the relay level doesn't mean the network is censorship resistant. It just means that censorship is in the hands of the miners, potentially leading to even more centralization.

To summarize: Jimmy's position is that filters do work, and that node preferences with regard to what counts as spam or not should be respected.

It was then Peter Todd's turn. Unfortunately, he did not seem to have prepared a proper opening statement, which was disappointing. I would have liked to see a more formal argument.

Instead, Peter opened by asking Jimmy to define spam. Jimmy said "non-monetary transactions". Peter then highlighted that some of the txs that nodes currently filter are monetary transactions; moreover, there is no single definition of what counts as a monetary transaction. Peter brought up Luke trying to censor SatoshiDICE, which were clearly monetary transactions. Core's position, therefore, is to not take a stance on what is and isn't spam. Peter also argued that relay filters make it harder for small mining pools to find the most profitable txs, putting them at a disadvantage relative to larger mining pools, leading to centralization. He ended with the statement that he "just wants to build systems that are resilient to how other people choose to use bitcoin," which did earn him some applause.

Rebuttals

During rebuttals, Jimmy restated his assertions that filters work, but Peter brought up a good point in that they might work in a "narrow" sense, but that it won't stop people from finding creative ways around them. This gets to the heart of the whole OP_RETURN debate, where Core's position is that while OP_RETURN filters may work to filter out large OP_RETURNs, they haven't actually worked to prevent people from publishing arbitrary data. Peter did say that it would be more productive if this debate actually moved to the protocol level, rather than the node implementation level, which was interesting.

Cross X

Jimmy asked Peter if he would support LibreRelay or Core v31 relaying 1 sat outputs. Peter said yes, but that this should really be solved at the protocol level, like pruning dust outputs. Jimmy then accused Peter of supporting spam because 1 sat outputs are clearly not monetary transactions. Peter said there are technical things you can accomplish on the blockchain with 1 sat outputs that help support monetary transactions; I didn't follow his explanation that well, but it's related to L2 protocols. Jimmy then said that Peter is assuming good use cases for 1 sat outputs, and ignoring that they'll also be used for spam. Jimmy said the developers are not thinking adversarially, that they're assuming the possibility space will only be used for good, but that expanding OP_RETURN actually opens up a huge attack surface. This earned him some applause.

Peter rejected the notion that Core isn't thinking adversarially, and accused Jimmy of fear mongering. Jimmy brought up how removing the data limit in Taproot v1 is what gave rise to the millions of monkey jpegs, and used that as an example of Core not thinking adversarially. Peter said that Jimmy is simply wrong, that it was possible to put unlimited data in standard tx even before Taproot. (I don't know who's right). Jimmy said that the issue is, you don't know that *would have* been put in filters weren't in place. Peter went back to the assertion that even if you put in the filters, people will find ways to get around them. At this point the discussion felt like it was going in circles.

Closing statements

Nothing really new. Jimmy re-asserted that nodes should be allowed to do what they want with their nodes, and that filters are effective. Jimmy also said that it's bitcoin's monetary, not technological properties, that give it value; therefore its functioning as a purely monetary network should be preserved.

Peter said that Jimmy's vision wouldn't work because even if a bunch of nodes filter, other nodes won't, and the disfavored txs will find a way. Peter also asked what the difference is between a world in which nodes are choosing their own filters and a world in which nodes are obeying the OFAC sanctions list. (This earned applause, but I personally thought it was a bit of a straw man). Peter then said, if relay filters ultimately don't work, people will start going after the miners, and what then? Will we now demand censorship from the miners? Peter reiterated that he'd rather fix these issues at the consensus protocol level.

My thoughts

Overall, I thought Jimmy was more prepared, and my sense is that the audience was on his side (he garnered more applause). But I think I agree with Peter's position more---in the sense that I don't think this debate should be being had at the node implementation/relay level.

In the end, I don't think it's super productive to have this debate, because Core can do what Core wants---and if you don't like it you're free to use another implementation. I don't think Core's position has ever been you're not allowed to run your own filters, it's we don't want our implementation to have these filters. Ultimately, I find myself agreeing with certain points on both sides. With Peter, I'd agree that a segmented mempool is undesirable, and that it's too hard to define what spam is. With Jimmy, I'd agree that Core could be more careful, and remember that Bitcoin is primarily a monetary network, not a technology platform. I do think filters work, but only in the narrow sense of filtering out transactions that don't conform to rules, but not in the broader sense of filtering out undesirable spam. I agree with Peter that it's better to have a debate about consensus protocol than relay filters.

comments

132 sats \ 5 replies \ @Undisciplined 30 Oct

Thanks for summarizing, since there's no way I was going to watch it.

To your point at the end about trying to address the issue at the protocol level, I've seen Knotzis argue that it needs to be at the relay level because of the dynamic nature of spam that the Coremunists point out.

It sounds like Jimmy didn't touch on what I consider to be the most important part of this whole thing, which is that it's at the relay level that we don't have prices to act as deterrents. Bad actors can freeride on the relay network to transmit illicit material that's never intended to wind up in blocks, at least as I understand the situation.

→ 42 sats \ 3 replies \ @Scoresby 30 Oct

How is a bad actor free-riding on the relay network different than a person who is bidding against you for blockspace?

Wouldn't any rational noderunner refuse to relay all transactions but their own?

(My personal opinion is that the relay network was designed to benefit miners, and noderunners are willing to participate because it's in their interest for mining to be a game anyone can easily jump in to.)

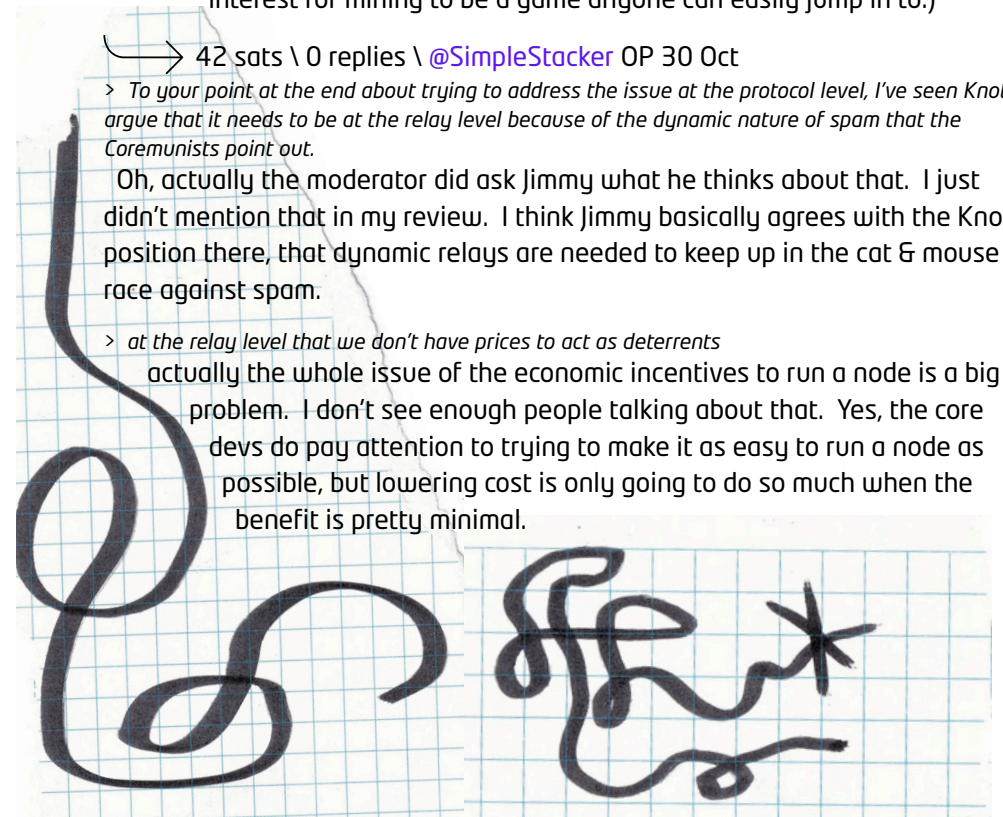
→ 42 sats \ 0 replies \ @SimpleStacker OP 30 Oct

> To your point at the end about trying to address the issue at the protocol level, I've seen Knotzis argue that it needs to be at the relay level because of the dynamic nature of spam that the Coremunists point out.

Oh, actually the moderator did ask Jimmy what he thinks about that. I just didn't mention that in my review. I think Jimmy basically agrees with the Knots position there, that dynamic relays are needed to keep up in the cat & mouse race against spam.

> at the relay level that we don't have prices to act as deterrents

actually the whole issue of the economic incentives to run a node is a big problem. I don't see enough people talking about that. Yes, the core devs do pay attention to trying to make it as easy to run a node as possible, but lowering cost is only going to do so much when the benefit is pretty minimal.





Turn ANY 3d printer into the ultimate orange pilling machine

1369 sats \ 3 comments \ @jasonb 31 oct bitcoin

Always tip with real money

I've been volunteering with Bitcoin Ekasi for the past few months and it's been so exciting to ask a merchant if they accept bitcoin with the strong expectation that the answer might be yes. When it's not...well, I'm not good at onboarding merchants. But I have had a lot of success onboarding employees who accept tips. Even in Ohio, USA, a true bitcoin wasteland, I would say that my success ratio of onboarding tip-takers is at least 10% of the total that I talk to. Here, I'm guessing that I'm seriously over 50% successful.

That said, accepting a tip using a smart phone is a drag! Let me show you how to really seal the deal with even the most rudimentary 3d printer. But first, in order to better understand how this guide came about, let's look at some fun things you can buy the next time you're in Mossel Bay.

Some of my more fun jobs at Bitcoin Ekasi

3d printer

One of the first things I was asked to do was train some of the guys on using the 3d printer. The 3d printer was quite literally collecting dust when we started this process, but now we're getting into a rhythm in which it's working around the clock. We started with the obvious.



Then we made some of our own brand and design.

...



Business onboarding

So I just got done getting up the thrift shop with a Bitcoinize POS machine that is connected to a BTCPay Server store that we made a couple of weeks ago. It's awesome, but most local businesses here still just use a simple Blink wallet. It's not ideal for a number of reasons I'll post on soon, but it's the reality of quick and dirty lightning onboarding. The problem is, what do you do when the person with the Blink wallet (usually the owner) isn't around? I encountered this situation enough times that I finally decided to just use the 3d printer that we have to make them a durable QR code that could just stay at the register.

Again, this isn't ideal for a number of reasons, but at least it makes it possible to always accept bitcoin payments.

Tip-taker onboarding

What it is ideal for is tips. Luthando suggested servers could wear QR codes of their lightning address on necklaces. We've made both that and a keychain version now for those who want to be a little more subtle.

As I mentioned at the beginning, these folks are your lowest hanging fruit for orange pilling. This is a true peer to peer tip and, in my opinion, significantly better than just putting more on your payment to the business, which then has to transfer the money to your server. But now, they don't have to pull out their phone, log into their phone, open their wallet, do a dance, press the receive button, press the QR code button, and then hope you're still awake. With the new option, they can just pull out a keychain and bring home the bacon.

It's also nice to have a way to receive payments when traveling through areas in which you don't want to bring your phone.



The actual freaking tutorial

